

Virat Kohli^[b] (born 5 November 1988) is an Indian [international cricketer](#) and former all-format [captain](#) of the [Indian national cricket team](#). He is a right-handed [batter](#) and an occasional right-arm medium-[pace bowler](#). Considered one of the greatest batters in limited-overs cricket, he has been acclaimed for his batting skills and records. Kohli has the [most centuries in ODIs](#) and the [second-most centuries in international cricket](#) with [85 tons](#) across all formats. He is also the leading run-scorer in the [Indian Premier League](#).

Kohli has won ten [ICC Awards](#), making him the most awarded player in international cricket history. He won the [ODI Player of the Year](#) award four times, in 2012, 2017, 2018, and 2023. He won the [Cricketer of the Year](#) award on two occasions, in 2017 and 2018. In 2018, he became the first player to win all three major ICC awards including Cricketer of the Year, ODI Player of the Year and Test Player of the Year in the same year. He was honored with the Spirit of Cricket Award in 2019 and given the [Cricketer of the Decade](#) and ODI Cricketer of the Decade in 2020. Kohli was named the [Wisden Leading Cricketer in the](#) Kohli's junior cricket career kicked off in October 2002 at the [Luhnu Cricket Ground](#) against [Himachal Pradesh](#). His first [half-century](#) in domestic cricket happened at [Feroze Shah Kotla](#), where he scored 70 [runs](#) against [Haryana](#).^[11] By the end of the season, he had amassed a total of 172 runs, emerging as the highest run-scorer for his team with an [average](#) of 34.40.^[12] During the 2003–04 season of [Polly Umrigar](#) Trophy, Kohli was appointed the [captain](#) of the U-15 team.^[12] He scored 54 runs in [Delhi](#)'s victory over Himachal Pradesh. In the next fixture against [Jammu and Kashmir](#), Kohli scored his maiden [century](#) with a score of 119. By the end of the season, he had a total of 390 runs at an average of 78, which included two centuries.^[13] Towards the end of 2004, Kohli earned selection for the 2004–05 [Vijay Merchant](#) Trophy with the Delhi U-17 team.^[12] In the four matches that he played, Kohli had a total of 470 runs, with his highest score being 251* runs. The team's coach, Ajit Chaudhary, lauded his performance and was particularly impressed with his temperament on the field.^[14] He commenced the 2005–06 season with a score of 227 against [Punjab](#). Following their victory over [Uttar Pradesh](#) in the quarter-finals, Delhi was scheduled to play against [Baroda](#) in the semi-finals. The team had high expectations from Kohli, who had promised his coach to finish the job. True to his word, Kohli went on to score 228 runs, leading Delhi to victory. The team later

Kohli was born on 5 November 1988 in [New Delhi](#) into a [Punjabi Hindu](#) family. His mother Saroj Kohli is a homemaker while his father Prem Nath Kohli worked as a [criminal lawyer](#). He has an elder brother Vikas and an elder sister Bhawna. His formative years were spent in [Uttam Nagar](#). His early education was at Vishal Bharti Public School.^[3] As per his family, Kohli exhibited an early affinity for cricket as a 3-year-old. He would pick up a [bat](#) and request his father bowl to him.^[4] In 1998, the [West Delhi Cricket Academy](#) was created. In May, his father arranged for him to meet [Rajkumar Sharma](#).^[5] Upon the suggestion of their neighbours, Kohli's father considered enrolling his son in a professional cricket academy, as they believed his ability merited more than [gully cricket](#).^[6]

Kohli was unable to secure a place in the U-14 Delhi team, due to extraneous factors. His father reportedly received offers to relocate his son to influential clubs, which would ensure his selection, but he declined the proposals. Kohli eventually found his way into the U-15 team.^[7] He received training at the academy and participated in matches at the [Sumeet Dogra](#) Academy located at [Vasundhara Enclave](#).^[8] To further his cricket career, he transferred to Saviour Convent School during his ninth grade.^[6] On 18 December 2006, his father died due to a [cerebral attack](#).^[9] As per his mother, Kohli's demeanour shifted noticeably after his father's death. He took on cricket with newfound seriousness, prioritizing playing time and dedicating himself fully to the sport.^[6] Kohli's family resided in [Meera Bagh](#), [Paschim Vihar](#) until 2015, after which they relocated to [Gurgaon](#).

the [Khel Ratna Award](#), in 2018. [Time](#) included him on its [100 most influential people in the world](#) list in 2018. Kohli has been deemed one of the most commercially valuable athletes, with estimated earnings of ₹634 crore (US\$66 million) in 2022. After winning the [2024 T20 World Cup](#) being named Player of the Match award in the [final](#), Kohli announced his retirement from T20Is. On 12 May 2025, at the age of 36, he announced his retirement from the Test cricket. He is married to actress [Anushka Sharma](#), and they have two children.

secured the tournament with a five-wicket win over [Mumbai](#), where he contributed with a half-century in the first [innings](#).^[15] He ended as the highest run-scorer with a total of 757 runs from 7 matches, averaging 84.11.^[16] On 18 February 2006, Kohli made his debut in [List A](#) cricket, playing against [Services](#) in the [Ranji One-Day Trophy](#), but he did not get the opportunity to bat during the match.^[16] In 2006, Kohli got a spot in the state senior team. Subsequently, he made his [first-class](#) debut on 23 November 2006, during the opening match of the [Ranji Trophy](#) season against [Tamil Nadu](#). However, his debut innings was a brief one, as he was dismissed after scoring ten runs.^[17] In the subsequent match against former champions, [Karnataka](#), Delhi found themselves trailing with a score of 130/5, with Kohli remaining unbeaten on 40 at the end of the day's play. That night, Kohli's father died. Despite the heart-wrenching news, Kohli returned to the match and continued to bat and scored 90 runs before he was dismissed.^[18] [Chetan Chauhan](#), the coach, was impressed by his determination and unwavering attitude in the face of adversity. [Venkatesh Prasad](#) lauded his crucial knock, which was executed in the midst of an emotional upheaval. After his dismissal, Kohli attended his father's funeral. His innings proved to be crucial for Delhi as they were able to avoid the [follow-on](#). The team's captain, [Mithun Manhas](#), praised Kohli for his performance, acknowledging its pivotal role in the team's success.^[19]

Kohli's foray into [T20](#) cricket first happened in April 2007, during the [Inter-State T20 Championship](#), where he emerged as the top run-getter for his team with a tally of 179 runs at an average of 35.80.^[20] In Sep 2008, Kohli played in [Nissar Trophy](#) against [SNGPL](#). He emerged as the leading scorer for Delhi in both innings, registering 52 runs in the first innings and a towering 197 in the second. The match ultimately ended in a [draw](#), SNGPL being declared the victors due to their lead in first innings.^[21] In the [2009–10 Ranji Trophy](#) season, Kohli returned to domestic cricket. During a match against [Maharashtra](#), he opened the batting and scored 67 runs, helping Delhi to secure the bonus point required for victory.^[22] Kohli's performance reinvigorated the competitive spirit of the domestic cricket circuit.